the line, and take down the first defensive player in the secondary.

I missed the linebacker by a mile and don't know to this day how Bud ever got through to make the touchdown. But during the game that I broadcast for Pete MacArthur, a right guard named *Reagan* leveled a block on the linebacker so furiously that it could have killed him.

Bud not only reached the end zone and tied the game, but drop-kicked the point-after-touchdown and won it for Eureka, *7—6*. With Eureka's fans cheering, I ended the broadcast, saying: *"We return you now to our main studio*. . . ."

When Pete clumped back into the studio, there was a smile on his face. "Ye did great, ye big SOB," he said. "Be here Saturday, you're broadcasting the Iowa-Minnesota Homecoming game. You'll get $5 and bus fare."

During the next week I read everything I could about the teams and Big Ten football. On Saturday, I took a bus to Davenport, met Pete at WOC, and drove with him to Iowa City along with a staff announcer Pete was obviously keeping in reserve in case I blew my chance.

Once I was on the air, I tried to make the most of my opportunity and chose phrases and adjectives I hoped would give listeners visual images that would make them think they were in the stadium, and I laced my descriptions with background about the players and teams that I hoped would demonstrate that I knew what I was talking about.

When the game was over, Pete said I'd passed the test and that he wanted me to broadcast Iowa's three remaining games of the season for $10 each.

Well, not only could I now call myself a *sports announcer*, I'd gotten a hundred percent raise in a week's time.

For a twenty-one-year-old fresh out of college, broadcasting the Big Ten games was like a dream, and as the end of the season approached, I prayed the people at